

Ring tones, along with operator logos, have proven a popular method of personalising phones—a major industry has popped up to tailor to the needs of people to customise their phones, and newer phones include features to allow users to create their own tones. Many people enjoy personalising their phones, but some find certain ring tones annoying in public and in certain public situations.

Many companies have set up businesses selling ring tones, advertising them on television and Web sites. One criticism of the industry is the subscription some companies lock customers into, requiring them to actively cancel their account or be charged for unwanted messages and ring tones sent to them on a weekly basis. Newer phones equipped with Bluetooth or PC-link up allow users to transfer ring tones created on a PC to their phone for free. The user can even record their own tones themselves and place them on the phone.

In Germany, ring tones are heard so frequently that some species of birds have begun imitating them!